

PHASE 1 SLATE (2008–2012): 8 FILMS

Status: being built. Each film gets a full Film Dossier before it's locked.

#	Title	Release date	Owner	Dossier
1	Iron Man	Friday, May 2, 2008	Marc-Anthony Bullock	 pending
2	TBD			
3	TBD			
4	TBD			
5	TBD			
6	TBD			
7	TBD			
8	TBD			

FILM #1: IRON MAN (why it kicks everything off)

- **Character:** Tony Stark / Iron Man. First appearance: *Tales of Suspense* #39 (March 1963), Stan Lee, Larry Lieber, Don Heck and Jack Kirby.
- **Why Iron Man goes first, even though we own everyone:**
- **Thanos debuted in an Iron Man comic.** Jim Starlin introduced him in *Iron Man* #55 (Feb. 1973), so starting the Infinity Saga with Iron Man is comic-accurate at the very root.
- **He's the most grounded way in.** Iron Man runs on technology instead of magic, mutation or the cosmos, so a 2008 audience can believe it. Every later film makes the world a little bigger from there.
- **Tony pays for the Avengers.** On 616, Stark money builds the team and Stark's mansion becomes its home. The man who funds the Avengers should be the first one we meet.
- **S.H.I.E.L.D. fits naturally.** A defense contractor is exactly who Nick Fury would show up to see.
- **The underdog story matches the studio's.** It's a B-list hero from a studio that's never made a movie, starring an actor Hollywood wrote off. Tony, Marc-Anthony and Marvel all have something to prove.
- **Release date: Friday, May 2, 2008.** It's the first weekend of the summer season, a week ahead of *Speed Racer* (May 9) and three weeks ahead of *Indiana Jones and the Kingdom of the Crystal Skull* (May 22), which gives it room to hold on for several weekends.